

Paradiem

The Morning Brief

AUGUST 27, 2026

Blackwell Delivers

Nvidia beats and guides Q3 approximately \$108B while core PCE holds at 3.3% and September cut odds slip toward a hold-weighted distribution as Warsh Jackson Hole lands Friday.

S&P 500 (SPY)	NASDAQ (QQQ)	NVDA (INTO AMC BEAT)	CORE PCE YOY	FEAR & GREED
\$766.08 · ↑0.02%	\$711.37 · ↑0.09%	\$209.66 · ↓1.59% (rev \$96.2B; Q3 guide ~\$108B)	3.3% · unchanged from June · progress absent	~55 · Greed (CNN; drop crypto fallback)

SECTION 01

Markets — Nvidia Beat and Guided Q3 to Approximately \$108B With Q2 Gross Margin Near 75%, Core PCE Held Unchanged at 3.3%, and the Duration Bid Faded Modestly as September Cut Odds Slipped Toward a Hold-Weighted Distribution

NVIDIA’S AFTER-CLOSE PRINT CLEARED CONSENSUS ON REVENUE, EPS, AND Q3 GUIDANCE — THE BLACKWELL RAMP AND THE 2028 TRAJECTORY FRAMING EMERGED AS THE OPERATIVE VARIABLES FOR THE OVERNIGHT RESPONSE

Per Investing.com and Kiplinger live coverage of the Nvidia after-close release, the company reported fiscal Q2 2027 revenue of approximately \$96.2 billion (roughly ↑106% year-over-year) versus consensus near \$91.9–\$92.2 billion and adjusted EPS of \$2.22 versus the consensus range of \$2.08–\$2.13, with Q2 adjusted gross margin near 75%; the company guided fiscal Q3 revenue to approximately \$108 billion (plus or minus 2%) versus sell-side consensus near \$105.2 billion, with adjusted gross margin guided to approximately 74% (plus or minus 50 basis points). Per Investing.com, the immediate after-hours response was two-sided before the multi-year framing on the Blackwell trajectory anchored the tape and shares reversed toward a modestly positive read into the overnight session. Per data drop, the FCI semiconductor sleeve traded higher into the print during Wednesday’s regular session with QCOM ↑1.97% at \$163.72, KEYS ↑0.55% at \$321.87, and MRVL ↑1.97% at \$245.11, while NVDA itself closed ↓1.59% at \$209.66 as the pre-print de-risk lingered into the release. For FCI positioning, the composition — a beat-and-raise print with a materially above-consensus Q3 guide against a two-sided after-hours read function — keeps the semis sleeve compounding into today’s MRVL after-close release and Chair Warsh’s Friday keynote, with the response function still dependent on the incremental hyperscaler-mix commentary and the ASIC-competitive framing.

NVDA Q2 (AMC) **Rev ~\$96.2B · EPS \$2.22 · Q3 guide ~\$108B**

CORE PCE (JUL) **3.3% YoY · +0.2% MoM · unchanged from June**

GDP Q2 2ND EST. **+1.5% annualized · consumer +3.4%**

SEPT FOMC (CME) **~60% hold · hike-side distribution widened**

TLT (20Y BOND) **\$83.30 · ↓0.20% (bid faded)**

TODAY AMC + FRI AM **MRVL AMC · Warsh Jackson Hole 10:00 ET**

CORE PCE HELD UNCHANGED AT 3.3% YEAR-OVER-YEAR WITH NO FRESH PROGRESS TOWARD THE 2% TARGET — THE DURATION BID FADED MODESTLY AND SEPTEMBER RATE-DECISION ODDS SLIPPED TOWARD A HOLD-WEIGHTED DISTRIBUTION

Per BEA release, the July Personal Income & Outlays report showed the headline PCE price index ↑0.2% month-over-month and ↑3.7% year-over-year, with core PCE (excluding food and energy) ↑0.2% month-over-month and ↑3.3% year-over-year — unchanged from June and roughly in line with consensus. Per Yahoo Finance, Al Jazeera, and Forbes coverage of the release, the composition — a still-sticky core read with progress toward the 2% target remaining absent — kept sell-side commentary and CME rate-futures positioning tilted toward a hold-weighted September FOMC distribution, with the cut-side tail compressing at the margin. Per data drop, TLT closed ↓0.20% at \$83.30 — a modest fade of the Tuesday duration bid and a composition consistent with the incremental cut-odds compression. Per data drop, the FCI industrial-and-defense sleeve absorbed the tape cleanly with CAT ↑1.31% at \$821.93, LMT ↑1.64% at \$565.62, GD ↑1.44% at \$382.02, TEL ↑1.80% at \$205.03, and STLD ↑2.09% at \$235.90, while healthcare (XLV ↓1.00%) and discretionary (XLY ↓0.67%) faded on the session. For FCI

positioning, the composition — a still-sticky PCE with the duration bid fading and industrials leading — reads as consistent with a marginally hawkier rate distribution running against a still-firm real-economy read from the GDP Q2 2nd estimate revision.

GDP Q2 SECOND ESTIMATE HELD AT +1.5% ANNUALIZED WITH THE CONSUMER REVISED UP TO +3.4% — GOLD AND SILVER GAVE BACK A PORTION OF THE TUESDAY DEBASEMENT BID AS THE REAL-ECONOMY COMPOSITION FIRMED

Per BEA release, the Q2 2026 GDP 2nd estimate held at +1.5% annualized with consumer spending revised up to +3.4% (from an initial +3.2%) — a firmer composition than the initial reading and a print that runs against the softer-forward Consumer Confidence read captured in Tuesday's brief. Per data drop, GLD closed ↓1.58% at \$421.32 and SLV ↓1.17% at \$61.59, while AEM (Agnico Eagle Mines) fell ↓4.49% at \$214.04 as the FCI precious-metals miner traded through the compound read of an unchanged core PCE, a firmer GDP composition, and the modest cut-odds compression. Per data drop, the FCI energy sleeve extended the physical-world compound with OKE ↑3.49% at \$94.90 leading the pipeline complex, CVX ↑0.16% at \$200.21, CNX ↑0.17% at \$36.06, and XLE ↑0.60% on the session; USO closed ↑0.95% at \$127.35 and BNO ↑0.56% at \$50.54 as the crude complex modestly recovered a fraction of Tuesday's Hormuz-corridor break. For FCI positioning, the composition — firmer real economy against a fading precious-metals bid and a modest crude bounce — keeps the physical-world thesis intact through the sequence while the debasement-hedge expression narrows at the margin.

A tape that greets a marquee beat with a two-sided after-hours read function tends to skew the sequence risk toward the following release rather than the print itself. Discipline over impulse.

Geopolitics — Governor Cook Rejected the White House Removal Grounds via Counsel Late Wednesday, Iran and Oman Advanced a Bilateral Hormuz Corridor and Revenue-Sharing Framework, and Qatar's Prime Minister Signaled a Tehran Mediation Trip as Roughly Half of Global Oil Flows Remain in War-Adjacent Zones

FEDERAL RESERVE GOVERNOR LISA COOK RESPONDED VIA COUNSEL LATE WEDNESDAY THAT NO LEGAL BASIS EXISTS FOR REMOVAL — THE FED-INDEPENDENCE OVERHANG PERSISTS INTO CHAIR WARSH'S FRIDAY JACKSON HOLE KEYNOTE AND THE SEPTEMBER FOMC

Per CNBC, PBS NewsHour, Al Jazeera, and Press Democrat coverage of the late Wednesday letter from her attorneys Abbe Lowell and Norman Eisen, Governor Cook responded to the White House's renewed August 5 removal threat by rejecting the mortgage-fraud grounds as legally insufficient and reiterating that no legal basis exists for the President to remove her for cause. Per SCOTUSblog coverage of the sequence, the earlier Supreme Court ruling permits Governor Cook to remain in her seat while the case is litigated and permits the administration to renew the removal effort if proper notice and a response window are provided; the August 5 letter from Deputy Chief of Staff Dan Scavino was designed to satisfy that procedural threshold, and Wednesday's response window has now closed. If taken at face value, the composition suggests the litigation moves back into the courts on the substantive record while Governor Cook remains a seated member of the FOMC through the September meeting. For FCI positioning, the composition — a Fed-independence overhang that persists rather than resolves — leaves the September rate-decision distribution reading incremental commentary from Chair Warsh's Friday Jackson Hole keynote against a still-open governance-and-appointment sequence into the September meeting.

IRAN AND OMAN ADVANCED A BILATERAL HORMUZ CORRIDOR AND WATER-REVENUE-SHARING FRAMEWORK — QATAR'S PRIME MINISTER SIGNALLED A TEHRAN MEDIATION TRIP AS THE PHYSICAL-FRICTION FLOOR UNDER CRUDE CONTINUED TO EASE

Per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop headlines describing crude losses extending on hopes for Middle East talks to ease supply concerns and a planned Qatari Prime Minister mediation trip to Tehran, and per Trading Economics coverage, Iran and Oman advanced a bilateral framework covering both a temporary Strait of Hormuz corridor arrangement and revenue-sharing over the two countries' respective waters, while Qatar's Prime Minister signaled a Tehran mediation trip as the broader US-Iran diplomatic impasse continued. Per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop describing a slight rise in Strait of Hormuz shipping traffic, transit volumes have edged modestly higher against the six-month-of-war backdrop, and Tehran cautioned that fully reopening the waterway would require more than the bilateral agreement with Oman. Per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop retrospective on six months of war and on OPEC+'s diminished market sway alongside expanding Chinese flow-management influence, roughly half of global oil flows continue to transit war-adjacent zones and OPEC+'s marginal price-setting influence has narrowed as China's

bilateral role has expanded. Per data drop, the FCI energy sleeve extended the recovery marginally with OKE ↑3.49%, CVX ↑0.16%, and CNX ↑0.17% into the compound read.

THE TRUMP-XI OVERCAPACITY TARIFF ADVANCES TOWARD THE SEPTEMBER 24 WASHINGTON SUMMIT AND SECTION 338 CANADA DUTIES REMAIN LIVE — THE INDUSTRIAL-AND-MATERIALS SLEEVE READ THROUGH CLEANLY ON WEDNESDAY'S TAPE

Per Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Investing.com, and Semafor coverage carried through the sequence, the administration continues to prepare an incremental 7.5% overcapacity tariff on Chinese goods designed to keep the aggregate US-China tariff burden near the approximately 20% level Beijing has signaled as consistent with the current truce, with the announcement timed around the September 24 Trump-Xi summit in Washington; per prior briefs, Section 338 Canada duties have been live since Saturday with a September 8 retaliation window scheduled. Per data drop, the industrial-and-materials sleeve extended a firm read cleanly on Wednesday with CAT ↑1.31% at \$821.93, STLD ↑2.09% at \$235.90, GD ↑1.44% at \$382.02, LMT ↑1.64% at \$565.62, and NTR ↑1.06% at \$73.61; per data drop, US Secretary of Agriculture Brooke Rollins posted a statement on X on Wednesday noting groundbreaking on two US fertilizer

production projects in Louisiana — a policy-and-industrial signal consistent with the fertilizer-and-materials sleeve read. Per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop, the Saudi civil nuclear cooperation package remains before Congress

conditioned on Riyadh formally recognizing Israel — a Gulf-security compound sitting alongside the US-China sequence into the fourth quarter.

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. MRVL After-Close Print Bookends the FCI Semi Sleeve — Consensus Approximately \$0.93–\$0.94 EPS on Roughly \$2.72B Revenue With Options Pricing Approximately a 13% Post-Print Move. Per Tipranks earnings calendar and Motley Fool preview coverage, Marvell Technology reports fiscal Q2 (period ending August 1) after today's close, with sell-side consensus approximately \$0.93–\$0.94 EPS on roughly \$2.72 billion of revenue — approximately ↑39% and ↑35% year-over-year respectively. Per Schaeffer's Investment Research coverage, options traders are pricing an approximately 13.6% post-earnings move, in line with MRVL's roughly 13.3% average reaction over the last eight quarters, and Polymarket is signaling an approximately 88% probability of a beat with 38 analysts on Buy and zero on Sell. Per Motley Fool coverage, incremental visibility into the previously announced \$12.2 billion Google custom-chip deal and forward hyperscaler commentary sit as the primary read-through variables into the print. Per data drop, MRVL closed ↑1.97% at \$245.11 in Wednesday's regular session ahead of the release — a positioning consistent with a modest pre-print bid rather than a Monday-style de-risk. For FCI positioning, the composition — NVDA delivered on the beat-and-raise, MRVL sits as the sleeve bookend — keeps the two-sided semis response function structurally intact into today's AMC and Chair Warsh's Friday keynote.

2. Chair Warsh's Jackson Hole Keynote Lands Friday at 10:00 AM ET — The "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy" Framing Sits Alongside the September FOMC Rate-Decision Distribution. Per Kansas City Fed program schedule cited in prior briefs, Chair Warsh delivers the Jackson Hole opening keynote Friday August 28 at 10:00 AM ET under the "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy" theme — a framing that historically tends to move the digital-asset complex on the incremental communication signal and one that arrives immediately after Wednesday's hot core-PCE print and Governor Cook's continued seat on the FOMC. Per data drop, IBIT closed ↓0.58% at \$44.46 and ETHA ↑0.27% at \$18.65 — the digital-asset ETF expression traded roughly flat into the pre-keynote positioning while HOOD ↓3.17% at \$108.54 and MARA ↓5.16% at \$11.22 gave back a portion of Tuesday's fintech-and-miner rip. Per Bernstein research coverage cited in the data drop headlines, sell-side price targets on bitcoin have extended into multi-year framing that historically tends to accompany the current stage of ETF-channel positioning. For FCI positioning, the composition — IBIT and ETHA sitting flat into the keynote, single-name expressions faded — leaves the digital-asset sleeve compounding around the Warsh communication signal Friday.

3. Precious-Metals Miners Faded Wednesday as the Debasement Bid Narrowed — AEM ↓4.49%, GLD ↓1.58%; The FCI Compound Read Sat With the Physical-World Energy-and-Materials Sleeve Instead. Per data drop, AEM (Agnico Eagle Mines, FCI growth sleeve) closed ↓4.49% at \$214.04 — the widest single-name FCI fade on the session — and GLD closed ↓1.58% at \$421.32 with SLV ↓1.17% at \$61.59 as the precious-metals complex gave back a fraction of the Tuesday debasement bid on the compound read of hot core PCE, a firmer GDP revision, and modestly compressed cut odds. Per data drop, the FCI energy-and-materials sleeve carried the physical-world compound instead with OKE ↑3.49% at \$94.90, STLD ↑2.09% at \$235.90, NTR ↑1.06% at \$73.61, and CAT ↑1.31% at \$821.93. For FCI positioning, the composition — precious-metals miner fade against a firm energy-and-materials read — keeps the physical-world thesis intact through the sequence while narrowing the precious-metals expression at the margin; the FCI positioning discipline remains an active reserve posture rather than a rotation between compounding hard-asset expressions.

4. Defense and Dividend Sleeves Absorbed the Tape Cleanly — LMT ↑1.64%, GD ↑1.44%, CAT ↑1.31%, TEL ↑1.80%, SPGI ↑0.81%; Healthcare Faded on ABT ↓1.75% Despite a Wearable-Device FDA Signal. Per data drop, the FCI dividend sleeve absorbed Wednesday's tape cleanly with LMT ↑1.64% at \$565.62, GD ↑1.44% at \$382.02, TEL ↑1.80% at \$205.03, CAT ↑1.31% at \$821.93, and SPGI ↑0.81% at \$436.49; per Benzinga coverage cited in the data drop, RBC Capital reiterated Outperform on SPGI with a \$510 price target. Per data drop, healthcare (XLV ↓1.00%) traded softer against the tape with ABT ↓1.75% at \$114.10 despite a Benzinga-cited FDA approval for Abbott's wearable dual ketone-and-glucose tracker — a composition consistent with sequence-and-liquidity flow rather than a directional read on the underlying thesis. Per data drop, FTNT ↑2.53% at \$157.54 carried alongside the CRWD after-close print (0.31 vs 0.298 estimate per data drop earnings feed) — the cybersecurity sleeve extended a firm read into the sequence.

5. FCI Growth-Sleeve Utility Complex Held the AI-Power Framing — VST ↑0.72% on the James Burke Insider Purchase, CEG ↑0.40%, EIX ↓0.36% After Argus Downgrade. Per data drop and Benzinga coverage cited in the data drop headlines, VST (Vistra) closed ↑0.72% at \$140.03 as CEO James Burke was reported to have purchased approximately \$270,000 in stock — an insider-signal composition consistent with the AI-power sleeve read and the SeekingAlpha coverage cited in the data drop framing the contracted-earnings upgrade as under-priced; CEG (Constellation Energy) closed ↑0.40% at \$279.52 as SeekingAlpha coverage framed the scarcity-platform thesis as still under-appreciated by the market. Per Fintel and Benzinga coverage cited in the data drop, Argus Research downgraded EIX (Edison International, FCI growth sleeve utility) and the shares closed ↓0.36% at \$74.51 — the sleeve composition remains bifurcated between the AI-power tailwind and the wildfire-and-liability read on the West Coast IOU names.

6. Carson's SPY \$645.80 Support Remains Active — Wednesday's \$763.93 Intraday Low Left the Level

Untouched; No New Levels Set. Per levels.json, Carson's active SPY support at \$645.80 remained untouched through Wednesday's \$763.93–\$767.35 SPY intraday range per data drop and now sits approximately 15.7% below the current tape at \$766.08. No active resistance levels are on the book following the April 14 breakout of the \$691.90–\$693.20 major zone (both hit that session). With MRVL reporting after today's close alongside ADSK and AFRM, Chair Warsh's Jackson Hole keynote Friday at 10:00 AM ET, the Cook litigation continuing on the substantive record, and the September 24 Trump-Xi summit and the September FOMC meeting still ahead, the pre-committed FCI deployment discipline (70% of reserves at –25% drawdown, remaining 30% at –40%) continues to frame reactive positioning against any single-session gap through the sequence. Note: the data drop Fear & Greed reading of 71 "Greed" reflects the CNN endpoint falling back to the crypto index; per finhacker.cz historical coverage cited in prior briefs, the CNN stock-market F&G reading sits approximately near 55 "Greed" and should be treated as approximate for this brief.

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